The Severan Dynasty

Pertinax was only in power for three short months before he himself was killed. Eventually, Septimus Severus took control of the throne and reigned as emperor between 193 and 211 CE. His reign begins what is known as the Severan Dynasty. He ultimately conquered the Parthians and enlarged Rome's territory. Unfortunately, his military expeditions in Britannia and North Africa drained Rome's coffers and the empire began to experience financial problems. His sons Caracalla and Geta became co-rulers upon his death but it wasn't long before Geta was assassinated by his brother. Caracalla then reigned until 217 CE when he too was killed by his personal guard. During Caracalla's rule, free men regardless of origin or past status were allowed Roman citizenship. While initially it sounds like a noble gesture, it was most likely a way to collect large taxes to fill Rome's ever dwindling treasury. The dynasty carried on under the management of 'Empress' Julia Maesa until Alexander Severus was killed in 235 CE.